Welcome to Northwind Analytics

Northwind Analytics was founded in 2011 in Rotterdam by Ingrid Vos and Samir Haddad, two former port logistics engineers who believed that better forecasts could make supply chains calmer and cheaper. What began as a two-person consultancy is today a software company with 640 employees.

We operate four offices. Our headquarters remains in Rotterdam, where most of our engineering teams sit. The Austin office serves customers in the Americas and hosts our customer success organisation. Our Riyadh office opened in March 2023 to support the rapid growth of logistics and retail customers in the Gulf region, and our Singapore office covers Asia-Pacific.

This document combines two things: the employee handbook, which explains how we work and what you can expect from us, and the 2024 annual report, which summarises how the company performed. Read it during your first week and keep it close; most everyday questions are answered somewhere in these pages.

Our mission is simple: help organisations see what is coming so they can plan with confidence. Our values are curiosity, candour and care. We expect everyone to ask questions, to give honest feedback with kindness, and to take responsibility for the people and systems around them.

Financial Results 2024

2024 was the strongest year in the history of Northwind Analytics. Total revenue reached €182.4 million, an increase of 14 percent compared with €160.0 million in 2023. Recurring subscription revenue represented 87 percent of the total, giving us a stable base for long-term investment.

Operating margin improved to 11.2 percent from 9.4 percent the year before, mainly because cloud infrastructure costs grew more slowly than revenue. Net profit for the year was €17.9 million. We ended the year with €64 million in cash and no debt.

Logistics companies remained our largest customer segment at 38 percent of revenue, followed by retail at 27 percent, manufacturing at 21 percent and energy at 14 percent. The number of customers paying more than €1 million per year grew from 31 to 42.

Geographically, Europe generated 52 percent of revenue, the Americas 29 percent, the Middle East 11 percent and Asia-Pacific 8 percent. The Middle East was the fastest growing region, with revenue up 41 percent after the opening of the Riyadh office.

Our Products

Beacon is our demand forecasting platform and the product the company was built on. Launched in 2016, Beacon combines statistical models with machine learning to predict demand for millions of products and locations every night.

Harbor is our data integration pipeline. It connects to customer systems such as ERP, warehouse management and point-of-sale software, cleans the data and keeps it synchronised. Harbor accounts for 41 percent of company revenue and is now our largest product line, ahead of Beacon at 39 percent.

Tide is the dashboard and alerting layer used by planners. It shows forecast accuracy, inventory risks and recommended actions. Tide makes up the remaining 20 percent of revenue and is included in most enterprise contracts.

All three products run on our shared cloud platform, which is hosted in data centres in Frankfurt, Virginia, Dammam and Singapore so that customer data can stay in its home region.

Working Hours and Remote Work

We trust people to organise their own time. Core collaboration hours are from 10:00 to 15:00 local time; outside those hours you are free to plan your day as you see fit, as long as your team knows how to reach you.

Employees may work remotely for up to three days per week. Teams agree together which days they meet in the office, and managers may approve fully remote arrangements for specific roles. Working from another country for more than 20 days per year requires approval from HR because of tax rules.

To set up a comfortable home workplace, every employee receives a one-time equipment stipend of €600 that can be spent on a desk, chair, monitor or other furniture. We also pay a home office internet allowance of €35 per month together with your salary.

Overtime is not expected as a normal way of working. If a project requires extra hours, agree compensation time with your manager within the same month.

Leave and Time Off

Full-time employees receive 27 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. After every five years of service you receive one additional day, up to a maximum of 31 days. Up to five unused days may be carried over to the next year and must be used before the end of March.

If you are ill, inform your manager before 09:30 on the first day of absence. A doctor's note is required only for absences longer than five consecutive working days. Sick leave does not reduce your annual leave.

Parental leave is generous because families matter. The primary caregiver receives 16 weeks of fully paid parental leave, and the secondary caregiver receives 6 weeks of fully paid leave, which can be taken at any time during the first year after birth or adoption.

We also offer two paid volunteering days per year and special leave for moving house, a wedding or the death of a close relative.

Compensation and Benefits

Salaries are reviewed once a year, every April, based on performance, market data and the scope of your role. We publish salary bands internally for every job level so that pay decisions are transparent.

All employees can earn an annual bonus of up to 12 percent of base salary. The bonus depends on company-wide revenue and customer satisfaction targets, not on individual ratings.

Northwind contributes 6 percent of your salary to the company pension plan, and matches any extra personal contribution up to a total of 8 percent.

Every employee has a personal learning budget of €1,500 per year for courses, conferences, books and certifications. Unused learning budget does not carry over. Language lessons are paid separately for employees who relocate to another office.

Travel and Expenses

All business trips must be booked through the Voyager travel portal so that we can support you if plans change. Book at least 14 days in advance whenever possible.

Flights shorter than six hours are booked in economy class. For flights of six hours or longer you may book business class. For trips under 700 kilometres, rail travel is the preferred option.

When travelling you receive a daily meal allowance of €55, which covers breakfast, lunch and dinner. Hotels should be in the standard business category; the portal shows the approved price limit for each city.

Submit expense claims within 30 days of the expense. Receipts are required for every expense above €25. Claims submitted after 90 days will not be reimbursed.

Information Security

Security is everyone's job. Passwords must be at least 14 characters long and unique for every system. Use Keyvault, the company password manager, to generate and store them; never write passwords down or share them in chat.

Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for email, source code, customer data and the HR system. All company laptops are protected with full-disk encryption and automatic screen lock after five minutes.

If you receive a suspicious email, do not click links or open attachments. Forward it to security@northwind.example and delete it. Phishing tests are sent a few times per year.

If a laptop or phone is lost or stolen, report it to the IT service desk within two hours so the device can be wiped remotely. Customer data must never be copied to personal devices or personal cloud storage.

Code of Conduct

We compete hard but fairly. Bribery, price fixing and misleading customers are never acceptable, no matter how important the deal.

Gifts and hospitality from suppliers or customers worth more than €75 must be declared to Compliance before they are accepted. Cash gifts may never be accepted. When in doubt, decline politely and ask.

Possible conflicts of interest, such as a second job, an investment in a supplier or a family relationship with a colleague you manage, must be reported using the conflict of interest form.

If you see something that looks wrong, speak up. You can talk to your manager, HR or Compliance, or use the whistleblowing hotline operated by the independent firm ClearLine. Reports to ClearLine can be made anonymously, by phone or online, 24 hours a day, and retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is forbidden.

Sustainability

In 2024 our total greenhouse gas emissions were 4,120 tonnes of CO2 equivalent, a reduction of 9 percent compared with 2023, even though the company grew. Cloud computing and business travel are our two largest sources of emissions.

We have committed to reach net zero emissions by 2035, with an interim target of halving emissions by 2030. Today 72 percent of the electricity we use comes from renewable sources, and all offices will use 100 percent renewable electricity from 2026.

Our forecasting products also help customers reduce waste: retail customers using Beacon reported on average 18 percent less spoiled fresh food in 2024.

Employees can lease a bicycle through the company, and public transport costs for commuting are fully reimbursed.

Onboarding and Performance

Every new joiner is assigned a buddy for the first 90 days. Your buddy is a colleague from another team who helps you find your way, introduces you to people and answers the questions you might not want to ask your manager.

The probation period lasts three months. At the end of probation you and your manager hold a short review to agree on goals for the rest of the year.

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and December. Reviews use a rating scale from 1 to 5 and always include feedback from at least two peers. Ratings influence salary increases in April but not the annual bonus.

Career levels are described in the career framework, which explains what is expected at each level for engineers, designers, sales and support staff.

Outlook for 2025

For 2025 we expect revenue growth between 10 and 12 percent, driven by new customers in the Middle East and the launch of AI-assisted forecasting features in Beacon.

We plan to hire around 120 people in 2025, mostly engineers and customer success managers. A new office in São Paulo will open in the third quarter of 2025 to serve customers in Latin America.

Investment in research will rise to 19 percent of revenue. The main priority is a forecasting assistant that explains in plain language why a forecast changed and what a planner should do about it.

In closing, the founders thank every employee for an exceptional year. The company enters 2025 with strong finances, loyal customers and a clear focus: making forecasts that people understand and trust.